

Refreshing Vision

Opening the Windows of the Soul: Starter Excerpt

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What follows is drawn from the opening pages of *Refreshing Vision*, four of the book's own "read and do" activities so you can try Neuro-Fitness Training today, and the closing passage where Dr. Glen looks back on what this work has meant in his own life. It is offered here in his own words, lightly arranged.

Foreword

As a young boy, I was lost, awash in the sea of compulsory public education. I was a C student in second grade, and was becoming nearsighted, pulling my space world in to magnify the symbolic world of written language. My father was a pioneer in the field of vision development, and during the following summer, he put me through an intensive training program of activities designed to stimulate development of a wide range of visually related functions, including spatial awareness, focusing, teaming, tracking, depth perception, eye-hand coordination, and simultaneous integration of all these functions with other related neurological circuits including balance, speech, and hearing. I have been an A student ever since, and my myopia has not progressed as it most likely would have through the many years of subsequent schooling.

I can still recall my experience as a child practicing many of those training activities, and even coming up with variations that my father later included in his Manual of Optometric Forms and Procedures for Visual Training, used by Doctors of Optometry around the world. When I completed my own doctoral training and established my first professional practice in Tokyo, Japan, I supervised the translation of my father's methods into Japanese. Now it is my time to share this remarkable work with the rest of the world...

Preface

Welcome to the Neuro-Fitness Training program. NFT can make a tremendous difference in the lives of both children and adults. I hope you will make a commitment

for yourself or your family to join us in building a better future, from the inside out.

Neuro-Fitness Training is a natural fruition of my years of experience in fields like visual training (thanks to my father, J. Baxter Swartwout, O.D., F.A.A.O., F.C.O.V.D., who helped to pioneer the field), intelligence education and biological medicine. I have designed these programs to support self-help on a home basis. Visual training, one of the foundational fields of this work, helped thousands of pilots develop the visual abilities needed to qualify to fly during the middle of the 20th century.

Factors that help leverage visual and neurological development:

- A stable electromagnetic brain environment
- Balanced brain biophysics and chemistry (Biofield Analysis)
- Self-directed action
- Guiding attention through questions
- Bringing awareness to sensory biofeedback within the activity
- Sustained focus of attention
- Slowing down, and creating interest in the activity
- Regular reinforcement of successes
- Frequent modification of the activity to sustain challenge without frustration
- Application of new skills in activities of daily living

Solutions: A 5-Phase Course You Can Start Today

Neuro-Fitness Training (NFT) is an integrated multi-phasic approach to optimizing neural functioning. NFT plays an important role in prevention, rehabilitation and enhancement of both cognitive performance, such as learning and memory, as well as sensorimotor functions including eye-hand coordination involved in athletics. The concept was developed by Dr. Glen Swartwout in 1994, based on his years of work in several functional rehabilitation fields, and is designed to assist anyone increase their mental and physical abilities as part of their total wellness plan.

There are 5 phases in NFT, which parallel the 5 phases of balancing body chemistry and bio-physics found in Dr. Swartwout's 5-phase health system. Achieving optimal health is more than merely having a balanced body. We should all strive to make the best of our mental abilities as well. Above all, we must direct our energies always toward that which will benefit our spiritual life.

Phase 1 consists of Preparation through correction of internal and external factors that influence neural development and performance. Of particular importance is elimination of key risk factors related to diet, supplementation, water, air, light, ergonomic building and furniture design, daily activities and other lifestyle regimens: consumption, environment, body, mind, and spirit. If a neuron's energy is being constantly depleted by a chronic stress pattern, it simply cannot respond to even the most appropriate stimulus, especially where interferences exist such as toxicities (e.g. the heavy metal lead impairs accommodation and learning), allergies (e.g. food reactions produce unstable neural chemistry states that impair the ability to build on past improvements), and unconscious avoidances (e.g. suppression zones in the visual fields produce unconscious blind spots for one out of three people). A Biofield Analysis consultation provides the starting point for exploring the unique individual impact of these foundational factors in preparation for an effective, efficient NFT and accelerated self-healing and development program. Remote Biofield Analysis, a process which has been used successfully for over 40 years with thousands of people, is a simple, painless, accurate, fascinating and profoundly effective way to peek into your bioenergetic physiology of light from another person's (surrogate) perspective. It can help reveal the blind spots in our growth and healing processes impossible for us to see for ourselves.

Phase 2 provides Stimulation of underactive or underutilized neural pathways: massage, stretching, movement patterning, self-expression, and direct sensory neuron stimulation, along with phototherapy and other activities and catalysts as determined in the Biofield Analysis.

Phase 3 is a program of daily neuro-developmental activities to support simultaneous Integration of all these essential, synergistic functions. Bringing awareness to the coordinated use of feet, hands, speech, audition and vision gently opens the mind and frees the spirit. The four activities below come from these two phases.

Phase 4 develops the key neural abilities required for facile and sustained Attention, concentrating without losing awareness and sustaining focus in a continuity of meaning. For many people, this is a rate-limiting step in the perceptual process. **Phase 5** trains the thinking skills of Perception: thinking, remembering, analyzing, and both creative and repetitive forms of productivity.

How can Neuro-Fitness Training benefit you? Stop living a series of reactions to daily crisis situations and set a new course, a pro-active one, toward the future you choose!

Try This: Four Read-and-Do Activities From the Book

Talking about Neuro-Fitness Training only goes so far. The heart of the book is a library of “read and do” activities like the four below, each with a stated purpose and simple instructions. None need any special equipment. Try one today.

Palming

State your purpose: “I am developing awareness and control of the ability to rest and refresh my eyes, while increasing the ease of circulation for my eyes.”

The right stuff: If desired, find something at chest height, while sitting, to rest your elbows on.

Read and do

1. Sit and warm up your hands by rubbing your palms vigorously together.
2. Place your softly cupped hands over your open eyes, with the heel of each hand resting on your cheekbone. The center of each palm is placed directly over each eye, without actually touching the eye.
3. To keep your neck and back straight with your shoulders relaxed, you can rest your elbows on a stack of books on your table or desk, or some other object at a comfortable chest height. The back of a chair placed in front of you may also work well.
4. Count 10 complete, relaxed breath cycles as you continue palming.
5. Try timing your palming sessions, and track how long your 10 breath cycles take to complete. The longer you take the better, as this means you are more relaxed and are breathing more fully.

Eye Stretch

For eyestrain or headaches related to activities like studies, desk work or computer use, try stretching your eye muscles. Many people learn how to stretch the skeletal muscles for sports or yoga, but the eyes are surrounded by six muscles each, and they can get tired, tight and sore, too, contributing to fatigue and headaches.

Try doing this activity periodically to break up any long periods of intense visual stress such as studying for finals, or writing a paper. A college student who was having severe headaches from studying would even wake up in the morning with a headache still from

the day before. As soon as he started using the eye stretch to break the muscle tension pattern in his eyes, he could not only manage the headaches, but also wake rested and refreshed for the first time at college.

When you are doing the activity notice when your breath spontaneously deepens and slows on an inhalation. This is a sign that your whole nervous system is letting go of its armoring around the stressful pattern of activity. The breath naturally seeks a coherent 10-second cycle of inhalation and exhalation when you are at peace. You may also notice a general relaxation response, releasing tension in the neck and shoulders, allowing the shoulders to broaden and drop. Your spine may straighten and elongate, and you may experience an expanded sense of interior spaciousness in your body space.

State your purpose: “I am developing freedom of movement in the connective tissues around my eyes.”

The right stuff: No materials are needed.

Read and do

1. Stand in a relaxed posture, looking straight ahead with both eyes open.
2. Place the side of your index fingers against the skin to the right of each eye. Look to the left as you stretch the skin and connective tissues around your eyes to the right. Breathe in as you look to the left, and exhale as you look back to the center.
3. Now repeat this with your index fingers to the left of each eye, stretching to the left while looking to the right.
4. Next stretch downward with your fingers, contacting the skin just below your eyes, while looking upward.
5. Finally stretch the skin below your eyebrows upward with the sides of your index fingers.
6. Repeat this sequence 6 times, taking a longer, deeper breath each time as you are able to relax and stretch more.
7. Now try sustaining each stretch through one or more breath cycles. Work your way up to 6 cycles in each direction.

Interesting question: Can you visualize the oxygen from each breath circulating into the area you are stretching?

Double Thumb Gate

State your purpose: “I am developing simultaneous awareness with my two eyes and connecting this with other senses.”

The right stuff: No equipment needed.

Read and do

1. Standing comfortably with equal weight on both feet, and facing a blank wall (at first), hold your thumbs up at arms length in front of you about 4 inches apart. Look at the point on the wall that is directly between the two thumbs. Describe what you see, including the appearance of the thumbs. How many thumbs do you see? How does it change? Can you discover what you change internally that makes the appearance change?
2. Now begin to slowly move only the two arms and the eyes as a unit in various patterns, continuing to look directly between the location of the two thumbs to the wall. Move side to side, up and down, on both diagonals, in circles both directions, as well as random shapes. As you get better, try tracing the outline of objects in the room.
3. Wiggle one thumb and think about which image you feel the wiggle in. Now can you think the wiggle into the other image? Try this wiggling the other thumb. Now try wiggling both thumbs at the same time. Can you feel the wiggle in both right images, both left images, the middle two and the outer two?
4. Make a sound with one thumb by clicking the thumbnail against a fingernail of any finger on the same hand. Locate and move this sensation around to both of the thumb images like you did with the wiggle.

Interesting question: Do you ever see just 2 thumbs or 3? What happens, and which images look more real or more faded?

Balance Sequence

State your purpose: “I am developing my body concept, balance and control while still and in motion.”

The right stuff: No equipment needed.

Read and do: Practice each step until you can do it reasonably well, before going on to the next step.

1. Get on your hands and knees on the floor. Raise one hand in the air. When you can keep your balance, repeat, raising the other hand instead. Count to 10 while keeping your balance.
2. Raise one leg instead of a hand. Again count to 10 while keeping balance, first with one leg raised, and then with the other raised.
3. Now raise the hand and leg on the same side at the same time. Count to 10 while balancing. Repeat with the other side.
4. Now raise the arm and leg on opposite sides, counting to 10. Repeat with the other pair.
5. Balance on your tiptoes for a count of 10.
6. Rise smoothly and evenly from a sitting position on the floor while keeping your arms folded on your chest.
7. Keep your balance while walking forward and backward on your knees.
8. Stand on one foot for a count of ten. Then try the other foot.
9. Repeat steps 5 and 8 with your eyes closed.
10. Maintain your balance while jumping on one foot with your eyes closed. First use one foot and then the other.

The book's full sequence continues from here into rhythmic, two-limb variations, but this arc alone will already tell you a great deal about your own balance and body awareness.

The Difference It Made

I give great thanks for the vision that has been given me, by the opportunity to stand on the shoulders of giants, as it were... My father, Baxter, as those close to him call him, and his predecessor, Skeff, as well as the myriads of other light workers in the remarkable field of functional, behavioral, developmental and rehabilitative optometry.

Had I not been graced and blessed with the visual training my father provided, my life would not be what it is. As a C student, I would not have become a high honors graduate of Dartmouth College. I would not have become a Doctor of Optometry at the top of my class at the State University of New York, rated in the top two doctoral programs for eye doctors. I pray that such a difference will open its potential in your life as you apply the methods and materials offered in this book.

There is much more waiting for you. This starter excerpt is only the foreword, preface, course outline, and a small sample of activities from *Refreshing Vision*. The full book walks through every phase in complete detail: the risk factors and lifestyle foundations behind clear seeing, biological terrain and diet, neuroprotection and antioxidants, minerals, vitamins and essential fatty acids, botanicals and homeopathy, and the full library of Neuro-Fitness Training activities, phase by phase and level by level, that Dr. Glen has used with his own patients, and in his own life, for decades.

If what you've just read resonates with where you are right now, and if trying even one of the activities above showed you something about your own vision, whether you're working on your own eyes, guiding a child's visual development, or coaching an athlete toward sharper performance, the full book of step by step 'read and do' activities could be your next step. Or if you are ready to begin Phase 1, a Biofield Analysis by Dr. Glen will include a face-to-face consultation to get you started on the right path.